GOALFI RESEARCH · SMALL-CAP FUNDS · 2026

The best small-cap funds aren't the biggest.

We ranked all 36 small-cap funds by their 2026 returns and by their size. Data up to 25 Sep 2026.

+32.25%

Best return this year (Bank of India Small Cap)

36 of 36

small-cap funds made money this year

0 of 10

biggest funds made the top 10 for returns

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Source: AMFI NAV data and fund portfolio disclosures · GoalFi analysis

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Top 10 small-cap funds by return

Returns from 1 Jan to 25 Sep 2026 (direct plans)

#	FUND	RETURN IN 2026	FUND SIZE (AUG 2026)
01	Bank of India Mutual Fund	+32.25%	₹3,308 Cr
02	Groww Mutual Fund	+29.87%*	₹764 Cr
03	SAMCO Mutual Fund	+28.32%	₹196 Cr
04	Trust Mutual Fund	+28.05%	₹3,441 Cr
05	Abakkus Mutual Fund	+25.44%*	₹2,795 Cr
06	Union Asset Management	+24.12%	₹2,667 Cr
07	ITI Mutual Fund	+22.75%	₹3,603 Cr
08	Motilal Oswal Asset Management	+22.11%	₹8,152 Cr
09	LIC Mutual Fund	+21.25%	₹832 Cr
10	JM Financial Mutual Fund	+21.13%	₹930 Cr

All 36 small-cap funds made money this year.
* Started in 2026, so the return is counted from launch (Groww: 2 Feb, Abakkus: 20 Mar).

Source: AMFI NAV data and fund portfolio disclosures · GoalFi analysis

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The 10 biggest small-cap funds

Fund size as of 31 Aug 2026, and how each did this year

#	FUND	FUND SIZE (AUG 2026)	RETURN IN 2026
01	Nippon India Mutual Fund	₹82,660 Cr	+11.23%
02	SBI Mutual Fund	₹42,625 Cr	+9.68%
03	HDFC Mutual Fund	₹41,916 Cr	+1.22%
04	quant Mutual Fund	₹35,557 Cr	+15.24%
05	Bandhan Mutual Fund	₹34,162 Cr	+13.22%
06	Axis Asset Management	₹31,439 Cr	+11.87%
07	DSP Mutual Fund	₹21,662 Cr	+19.08%
08	kotak Mutual Fund	₹19,687 Cr	+11.67%
09	HSBC Mutual Fund	₹19,067 Cr	+17.08%
10	Invesco Mutual Fund	₹15,742 Cr	+15.89%

None of these 10 made the top 10 for returns. The closest is DSP, at #12 of 36.
Together they hold 73.98% of all small-cap fund money (₹4,65,669 Cr).

Source: AMFI NAV data and fund portfolio disclosures · GoalFi analysis